

Nora Hammouti

Senior Design Project Manager — Innovation & R&D

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PROFILE

I work where innovation is still uncertain.

On innovation and R&D projects, I lead design expertise alongside the other project stakeholders, drawing on dedicated methodologies to inform decisions and structure project trajectories.

This design-led approach helps surface opportunities before they are even formulated, make complex hypotheses tangible, and align all stakeholders around a shared vision.

My role: turning emerging dynamics into concrete projects, leading my design team as one of the project's driving forces, from exploration through to industrialization.

EXPERTISE

Strategic design — R&D Innovation — Emerging technologies — Early-stage concept development — User research — Usage roadmap development — AI/ML interactions — Prototyping — User adoption — Industrialization support — Cross-functional leadership

PORTFOLIO

[→ link to portfolio](#)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Aug 2021 – Present

Senior Design Project Lead

EDF Pulse Design,

EDF Lab les Renardières (77) / Tour Légende (92)

Managing a portfolio of around ten innovation projects per year on average, primarily for the hydropower and nuclear business lines, some launched within the year and others carried over from the previous one, at the interface of three groups of stakeholders (my design team, R&D research engineers, and business referents), handling scheduling, technical/usage trade-offs and stakeholder alignment, from opportunity exploration through to proof of concept.

Management of budgetary resources (external services, direct costs) across the project portfolio, ensuring overall budget adherence at project level. Contribution to go/no-go continuation decisions based on usage relevance, factoring in maintenance and evolution considerations for deployed solutions from the earliest stages.

Depending on the briefs and topics at hand, selecting the appropriate expertise (designers, engineers) within my team, and using design and research tools (Figma/Figjam, Fusion 360, KeyShot, etc.).

5 demonstrators/prototypes delivered on average per year, roughly a third of which reached an industrialization or operational transfer phase. Design (UX/UI, industrial, foresight) is used as a decision-support tool to reduce uncertainty and speed up decision-making for project sponsors.

Example (nuclear): led user research to support the redesign of an immersive 3D digital training tool for nuclear operators: conducted qualitative interviews with trainees and instructors combined with quantitative analysis of usage data to understand navigation patterns and interpretation of complex technical information. Research also included a study on the profile of incoming trainees, a younger generation with different digital habits and learning expectations, informing how the tool's UX and pedagogical approach should evolve. Findings shaped new interaction and visualization models, the tool's UX overhaul, and its industrialization roadmap toward a web-based version.

Example (hydropower): led a mixed-methods research study on the field adoption of a commercially available drone, adapted to the specific requirements of dam surveillance, for dam safety monitoring: combined qualitative interviews and quantitative analysis to assess operational acceptance among supervising teams, and conducted a perception study

among external stakeholders (town hall, gendarmerie, fishing association) to understand trust and concerns. Findings were translated into usage scenarios, along with actionable recommendations that shaped the solution's rollout strategy. Follow-on work included a risk and failure analysis for the Rance tidal power plant.

Project co-led with a hydropower operations representative, a drone expert from the General Technical Division, and a nuclear sponsor (with a view to deploying the solution for EPR2 construction site monitoring) — winner of the **Jury Prize in the “Health & Safety” category at the 2026 EDF Pulse Awards**, selected and presented by Bernard Fontana, Chairman and CEO of EDF.

Jan 2020 – Jul 2021

Industrial Designer and Design Project Manager

Y.SPOT,
CEA Grenoble (38)

Led the design mission for 1 year on a spin-off project for a medical wearable device that broke with existing solutions in the sector. Responsible for the industrial design activities and deliverables (alongside a second designer, with no hierarchical relationship) and for the mechatronics workstream (one dedicated engineer). The project was handed over and continued after my departure.

Designed 3 technology demonstrators in micro- and nanotechnology, intended to show industrial partners how these technologies could address concrete applications.

Contributed to forward-looking studies on a range of technology topics, including early-stage thinking on the use cases and feasibility of an upper-limb exoskeleton (Clnatech Platform, CEA) for people with paraplegia.

Feb 2018 – Dec 2019

Product and Industrial Designer

Freelance Consultant,
EDF Lab les Renardières (77)

Design Lab, EDF R&D Renardières (external contractor): designed innovative solutions stemming from EDF's R&D, for operational business units and private consumers. Conducted foundational and applied user research for a digital context-aware assistance system developed by a R&D team, for nuclear power plant maintenance technicians: ran qualitative interviews with technicians to surface needs and pain points, combined with quantitative data analysis, to define usage scenarios and user journeys across intervention contexts — translating findings into visual and audio interface requirements. Also contributed to an exploratory IoT project reimagining energy-related household objects (light switch, clock, weather station), which was showcased at a design exhibition and featured in specialist press.

Sep 2016 – Jul 2017

Industrial Designer (freelance assignments)

ECAL (École Cantonale d'Art de Lausanne),
Lausanne (CH)

Designed bespoke concepts for various companies as part of school-supervised academic projects (Hermès, Retrosuperfuture, Vacheron Constantin, etc.), some in collaboration with the EPFL ECAL Lab — including a store window concept for Vacheron Constantin and an eyewear frame for Retrosuperfuture, made from upcycled acetate waste.

Aug 2015 – Sep 2016

Industrial Designer – Training Facilitator and Curriculum Engineer, Physics Engineering

Centrale Lyon ENISE,
Saint-Étienne (42)

Drew on a dual skill set — industrial design and teaching — to design curriculum modules in Physics Engineering, organize hands-on workshops, and support undergraduate to graduate-level students on their projects. Prospected and connected with private companies to source real-world topics and challenges for students to work on.

Jun 2014 – May 2015

Intern, then Junior Industrial Designer

Studio Klass,
Milan (IT)

Contributed to a self-supporting modular lighting system for FontanaArte: researched modularity options and proposed mechanical assembly systems for the modules, as well

Mar 2012 – Jul 2012

as researching materials for other functional prototypes. Later worked on research and development of industrial product concepts (ideation, modeling, 3D rendering) and produced client presentations.

Production Assistant Intern

Galerie Kreo,
Paris (75)

Tracked the fabrication of works with artisans and manufacturers: coordinated between designers, production workshops and the gallery to ensure piece conformity and deadlines were met. Notably contributed to production oversight for designer Brynjar Sigurðarson's piece, "The Silent Village Round Table".

EDUCATION

2017	Master of Advanced Studies HES-SO - Design for Luxury and Craftsmanship ECAL – École Cantonale d'Art de Lausanne (CH)
2013	DNSEP (French National Diploma in Visual Arts, Design track – equivalent to a Master's degree) ESADSE – École Supérieure d'Art et Design de Saint-Étienne (42)
2008	Bachelor's in Physics (2 years completed) UCL - Université Claude Bernard, Lyon 1 (69)
2005	Scientific Baccalaureate (French high-school diploma), Physics-Chemistry track Lycée Claude Fauriel, Saint-Étienne (42)

LANGUAGES

French — Native | English — Professional